

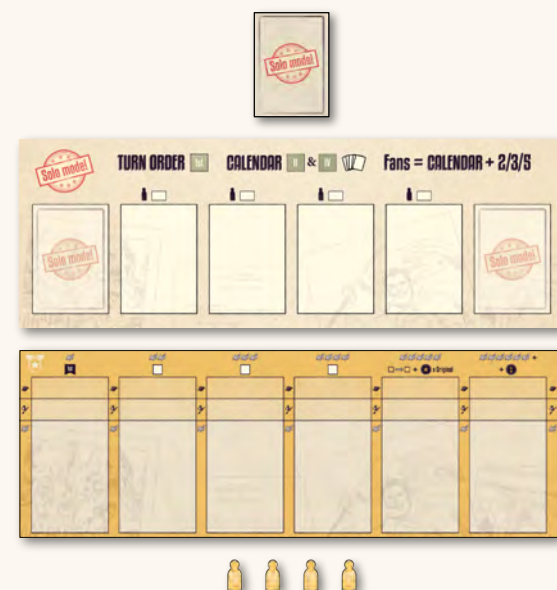
COMPONENTS

Note: These components are in addition to those listed in the base game rulebook. Please refer to it for the complete list of components and the rules of the game.

- 12 Automa cards
- 1 Automa mat (found on the reverse side of any player mat)
- 1 regular player mat of your choice
- 4 Editor meeples of the same color

Note: Each action attributed to the Automa is carried out by you, following the instructions on the Automa card and in this rulebook.

The Automa uses the Automa mat to display its Automa cards and a regular player mat to place its Creative teams and printed comic books. Its four Editor meeples are placed on the game board when resolving Automa actions.



SETUP

Set up the board and the game supply as in a 2-player game.

Position your player mat directly below the main board, then place the Automa mat to either side, as shown in the image below.

You play with the standard setup of the second player:

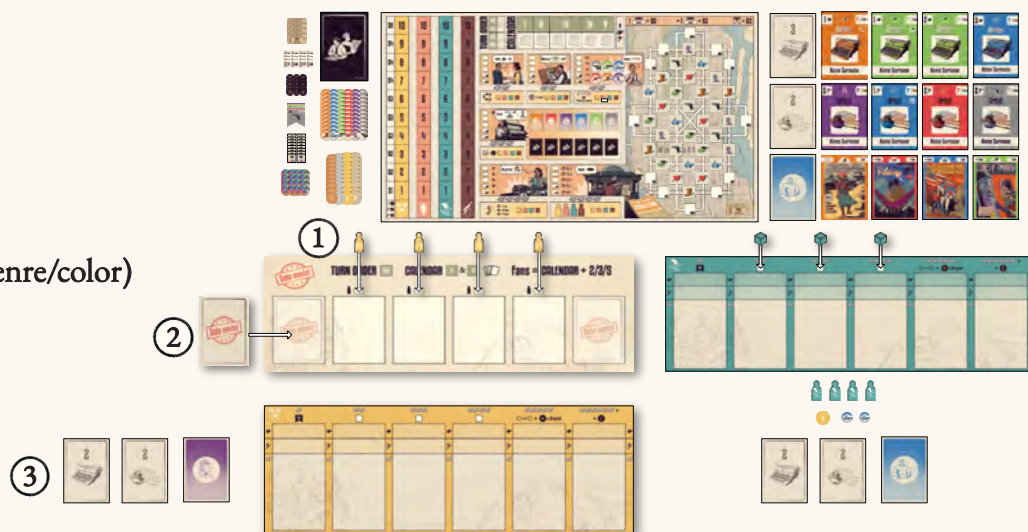
- 1 player mat of your choice
- 4 Editor meeples
- 3 Special Action cubes
- 1 Sales Agent token
- 3 Idea tokens of your choice
- 1 Writer card value 2 and 1 Artist card value 2 (not of the same genre/color)
- 1 face-down Comic Book card of your choice
- \$5

No Turn Order block is used.

Automa Setup

- ① Place the 4 Automa Editor meeples on the four action spaces of the Automa mat.
- ② Shuffle the 12 Automa cards and place the deck face down in the first slot of the Automa mat marked "Solo Mode".
- ③ Randomly select 1 Writer card value 2, 1 Artist card value 2, 1 Comic Book card and place these cards face up next to the regular player mat assigned to the Automa. Genre and color do not matter for these starting cards.
- ④ Choose a difficulty level: Beginner, Intermediate, or Expert (see p.3, PRINT section).

Note: The Automa **does not receive**: money, Idea tokens, a Sales Agent token, Special Action cubes, or a Turn Order block.



HOW THE AUTOMA WORKS

- The Automa always plays first.
- The Automa never earns or spends money and never performs actions other than those indicated on the Automa cards and described in this rulebook.
- At the beginning of each round, draw 4 Automa cards and place them face down on the 4 slots of the Automa mat.
- To begin its turn, flip the leftmost Automa card and resolve the first action shown, starting from the top of the card, following the rules in the “Automa Actions” section. (In the example on the right, the Automa would perform “Hire”.)



Note:

- **If** that action has already been performed at least once during the round, perform the second action instead. **If** the second action has also already been performed, perform the third action. (In the example on the right, “Develop”.)
- **If** all three actions shown on the Automa card have already been performed at least once during the round, the Automa may repeat an action. It selects the action from top to bottom as usual and places its Editor meeple in the first available slot of that action area, following the normal placement rules.
- **After the Automa completes its action, it is your turn.**
- At the end of the round, discard the 4 revealed Automa cards and place them in the discard slot of the Automa mat.

Actions



Genre priority

Genre Priority

Genre Priority is determined by the order of genres shown on the Automa card, from left to right. The leftmost genre has the highest priority. Whenever the Automa checks genres, it always checks them in that order.

Automa Deck Reset

At the end of rounds II and IV, shuffle the entire Automa deck, including both unused and discarded cards, and place it face down in the first slot of the Automa mat.

FAILED ACTION

Sometimes the Automa cannot perform the action indicated on the card for the reasons described in the “Automa Actions” section. When this happens, it performs a failed action. **If** a failed action occurs, the Automa attempts the next action listed on the same card.

AUTOMA ACTIONS

HIRE!



The Automa attempts to hire a Writer and an Artist of the same genre from the display, following **Genre Priority**.

If the Automa already has four Creative cards in its play area, it performs a failed action.

If there is not at least one face-up Writer and one face-up Artist available to hire, it performs a failed action. Check genres in priority order.

For the first genre that has at least one face-up Writer and one face-up Artist available, hire one of each from that genre.

If multiple cards are available, choose the highest value card for each.

If no matching pair is available in any genre, hire them separately: first choose the Writer of the highest priority genre available, then the Artist in the same way. In both cases, choose the highest value card of that genre.

If there is still a tie between eligible cards, choose from left to right among the face-up cards.

Once the choice has been made, place the selected cards in the Automa’s play area.

If the Automa hires a value 1 Creative, it does not receive the Idea token printed on that card.

DEVELOP!



If the Automa already has two developed (not printed) Comic Book cards in its play area, it performs a failed action.

If there are no Comic Book cards available either in the display or on top of the Comic Book deck, it performs a failed action.

The Automa checks the genre of the player’s most recently printed comic (the rightmost one on the player mat). It selects the first available Comic Book card of that genre from the display, scanning from right to left.

If no card of that genre is available in the display, the Automa instead checks the top card of the Comic Book deck. If it matches that genre, take it.

If no matching card is found, repeat this process using the player’s second-to-last printed comic, and so on.

If the player has not printed any comics, or none of those genres are available, the Automa instead follows Genre Priority. Reveal cards from the Comic Book deck until a matching genre is found. Discard the revealed cards and take the first matching one.

- 2 Once selected, place the Comic Book card in the Automa’s play area.

IDEAS!



If the Automa does not have at least one comic book in the chart: the Automa performs a failed action.
If there is not at least one Idea token available in the display, it performs a failed action.

The Automa removes Idea tokens from the game board according to the occupied action space (1 or 2), following Genre Priority, and discards them. Then, each of the Automa's three highest-ranked comic books in the chart gains 1 Fan.

If there is a tie in ranking, resolve it using Genre Priority. If the Automa has only one or two comic books in the chart, only those gain a Fan.

Note: The Automa never takes Idea tokens from the common supply.

PRINT!



If the Automa does not have at least one free Creative team, it performs a failed action.

Printing a Developed Comic: If the Automa has at least one developed comic book and one free Creative team, it prints one developed comic book using the first available team. Place the printed comic book on the Automa's player mat from left to right, as in the regular multiplayer game.

Matching genres/colors rules do not affect the Automa.

If the Automa has two or more developed comic books, it chooses the one that would earn a Mastery token, if possible.

If more than one would earn a Mastery token, it gives priority to the one that would remove a Mastery token from the player.

If there is still a tie, resolve it using Genre Priority.

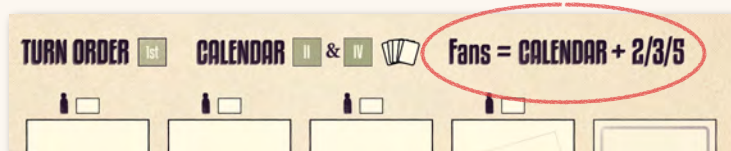
Fans (Developed Comics): When printing a developed comic book, the Automa does not calculate Fans as in the base game. Instead, it gains: Difficulty level value (2, 3, or 5) + the current round number (1–5).

Place the corresponding Mini Comic Book tile on the chart accordingly.

Mastery tokens work as in the base game: If the printed comic book earns a Mastery token, it gains +1 additional Fan.

Difficulty level and number of fans:

Beginner = 2 fans + round number
Intermediate = 3 fans + round number
Expert = 5 fans + round number



Printing a rip-off:

Fans: unlike the original comics, rip-offs earn fans equal to the level of difficulty (2,3,5) only, without adding the round number.

Print x2: If the Automa places its Editor meeple in the "Print x2" slot and has two free Creative teams, it prints two comic books (including rip-offs if applicable), resolving them one at a time.

SALES!



This action is divided into two steps: **FLIP** and **COLLECT**.

Required number: The number of tiles involved depends on the action space occupied by the Automa: 2 or 3 tiles.



FLIP:

If no genre on the map has at least the required number of Sales Order tiles, the Automa performs a failed action.

Otherwise, the Automa checks whether the map contains at least the required number of tiles of the same genre as the last comic printed by the player.

If not, it checks the previous comics printed by the player, starting from the most recent; if the player has not printed any comics, it proceeds according to Genre Priority.

Once the genre has been determined:

- If all tiles of that genre are already face up, proceed to the Collect step;
- otherwise, flip all tiles of that genre that are still face down, then proceed to the Collect step.

COLLECT:

The Automa collects 2 or 3 Sales Order tiles of the genre determined during the Flip step, depending on the action space occupied.

It **collects only face-up tiles** and always selects the **highest-value tiles available** up to the **required number**.

If the Automa has printed at least one comic, it gains **1 Fan for each tile collected**, assigned to its highest-ranked comic on the chart, regardless of genre.

ROYALTIES!

The Automa does not perform Royalties actions.

NO ACTION AVAILABLE

In the rare event that the Automa cannot perform any of the three actions shown on the card, it performs the first available action on the game board, scanning from left to right and from top to bottom.

END-OF-ROUND PHASE

Resolve end-of-round effects for both the Automa and the player as in the multiplayer game. Both lose fans and gain VP from ranking; the player also gains money.

Remember: At the end of the second and fourth rounds, shuffle the entire Automa deck (both unplayed cards and discards) and place it face down on the first space of the Automa mat.

END OF GAME SCORING

At the end of the solo game, make two separate performance assessments:

1. the challenge against the Automa
2. the player title (aka challenge against yourself)

1. CHALLENGE AGAINST THE AUTOMA

You win the game if you earn more VP than the Automa. The Automa gets VP by adding up the following:

- 1 VP for each fan in the chart at the end of the game
- Any VP earned from the end-of-round rankings throughout the game
- 2 VP for each Mastery token owned at the end of the game
- +18, +24, or +32 VP according to the difficulty level chosen at the beginning of the game (beginner, intermediate, or expert, respectively)

In case of a tie, the Automa wins.

2. PLAYER TITLE

Based on the total VP you earn (calculated as in the multiplayer game), you receive a title you can brag about to your friends. :)

110+	Publisher
100-109	Editor-in-Chief
90-99	Senior Editor
80-89	Associate Editor
70-79	Editor
60-69	Assistant Editor
50-59	Proofreader

MULTIPLE CHALLENGES (Game options)

Before starting the game, you may choose one or more additional challenges. If you do not meet the requirements of a chosen challenge by the end of the game, lose 15 VP for each unmet requirement.

Note: Be careful when choosing challenges, as some are not compatible with each other!

- **Action!** Finish the game with the following Mastery tokens: superheroes and western plus one more of your choice
- **Master of Fiction.** Finish the game with the following Mastery tokens: sci-fi and horror plus one more of your choice
- **Guns and flowers.** Finish the game with the following Mastery tokens: romance and crime plus one more of your choice
- **Edge of the business.** Finish the game with \$20 or more
- **Top and beyond.** Finish the game with a comic with 11+ fans (you can't use Hype tokens on that comic!)
- **35 or more** fans in total
- **12 or more** sales orders fulfilled
- **At least 1 comic book printed of each genre**
- **Ethical publisher.** No rip-offs printed